

EPI-LINK – DATA LINKAGES FOR IMPROVED EPIDEMIOLOGICAL SURVEILLANCE OF INFECTIOUS DISEASES

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Context

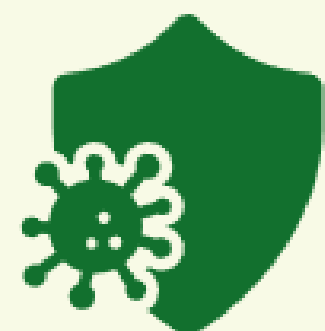
EPI-LINK creates a flexible data linking infrastructure for both routine surveillance and public health emergencies.



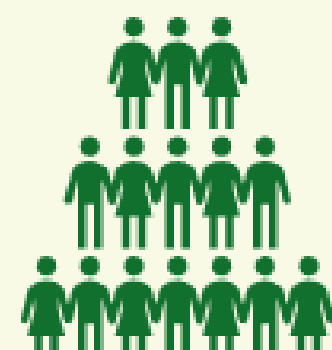
Routine surveillance



Improve data on vaccination and case detection



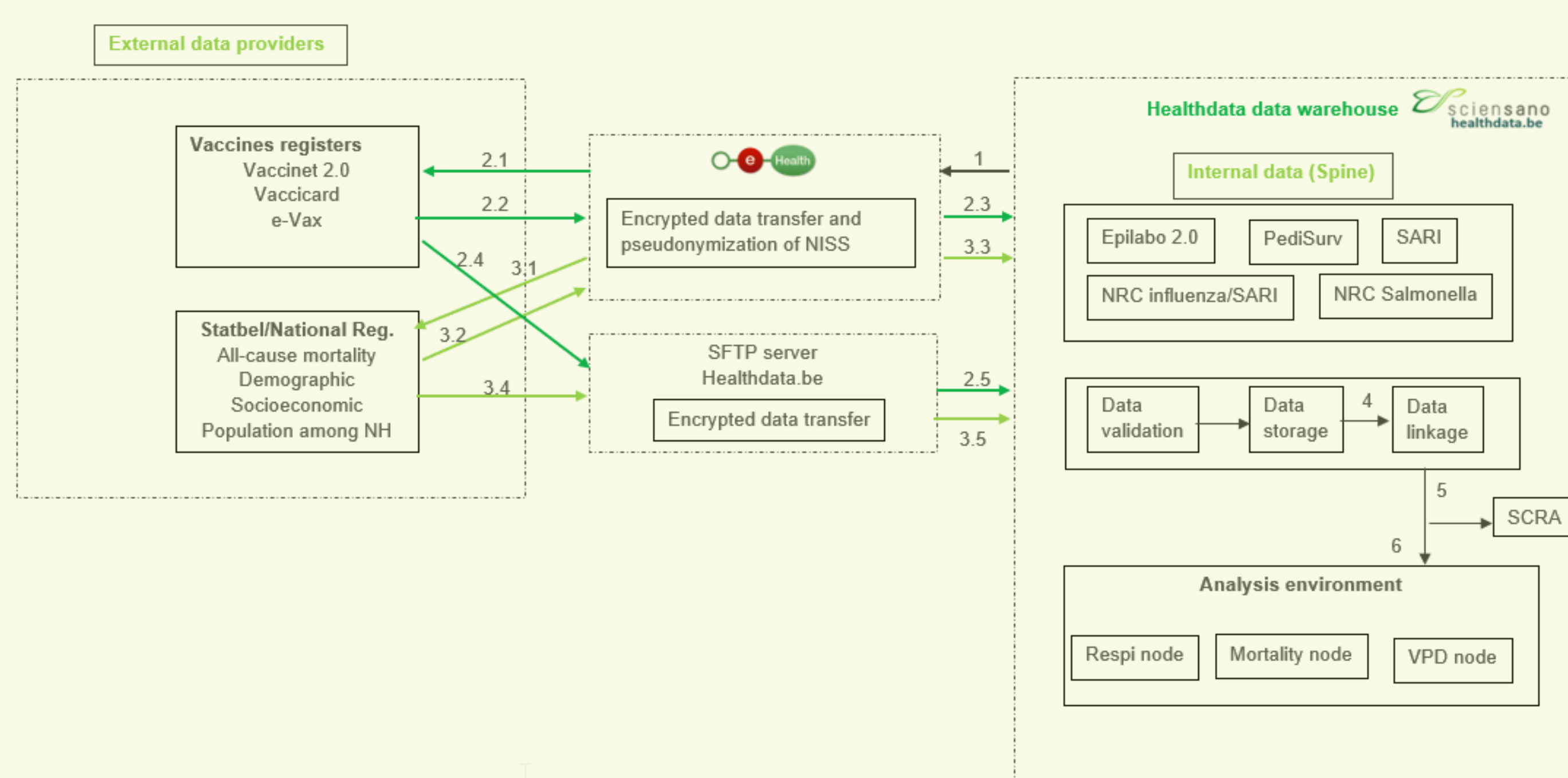
Estimate vaccine effectiveness



Assess socio-economic disparities

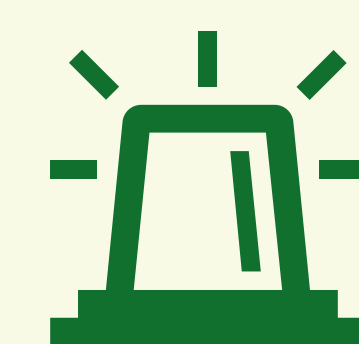


Monitor cause-specific mortality using a proxy



Methods

Individual linkage of laboratory test results and clinical hospital data with vaccination, mortality, socio-demographic, and healthcare consumption records.



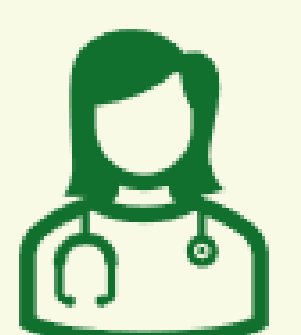
Public health emergencies



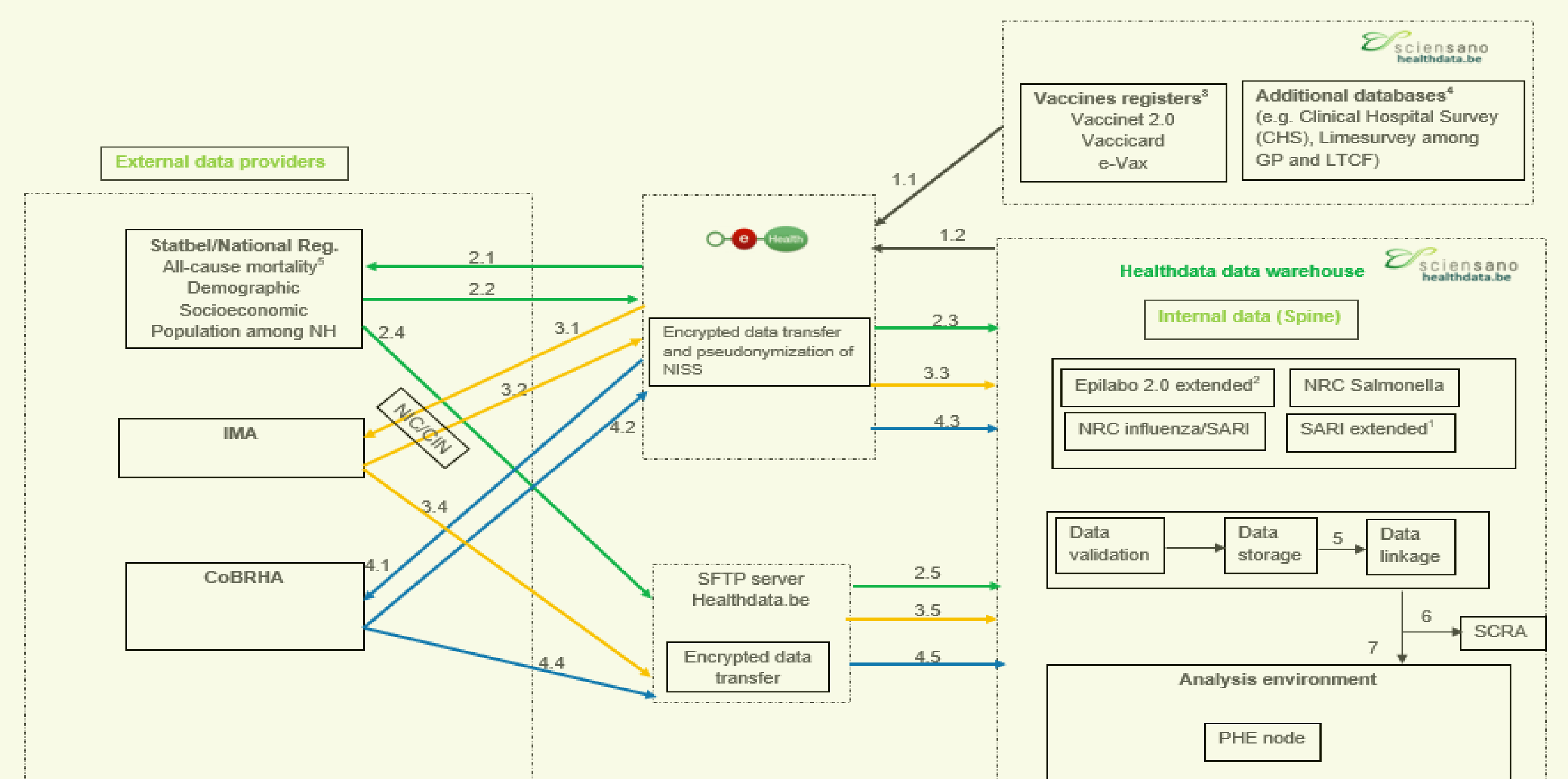
Monitor disease severity and risk factors



Evaluate vaccine uptake, safety and effectiveness



Assess disparities and health care worker impact



Conclusion

EPI-LINK will strengthen ongoing tracking of infectious diseases by **connecting different databases** at the individual level. This connection can be expanded to gather more detailed data, helping public health officials make **better decisions during emergencies**.